STATUS REPORT

Egypt — digital transformation and data governance status report

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

A cabinet meeting on presidential directives in July 2026 recast Egypt's digital transformation as an instrument for protecting public funds and governing state assets rather than primarily for service delivery, and directed every minister to produce a digital-transformation delivery plan. That is a change of purpose rather than of paperwork: the same estate, pointed at asset control instead of at the citizen queue.

The governing instrument is unchanged. Digital Egypt, published by the communications ministry, covers first, middle and last mile connectivity, digital identification, cybersecurity, e-commerce, payments, e-government services, digital market regulation, postal services, mobile wallets, broadband and artificial intelligence. Above it, digital transformation is one of the seven enablers of Egypt Vision 2030, which sets interoperability and government data exchange as strategic objectives. The World Bank records a current transformation strategy in force rather than expired, with a companion instrument in the same family still planned or in draft (2025).

Delivery is being pushed down to the governorates. The FY2026/27 development plan uses integrated population databases to assess governorate performance and to tie incentives to the results each governorate achieves on the population file. Nothing published about that arrangement establishes what the incentives are, who sets the governorate targets, what a governorate gains or loses, or what safeguards attach to a system measuring fertility and marriage at population scale (August 2026).

The record the strategies are written against is middling and patchy. Egypt scores 51.0 out of 100 for overall governance in the 2024 Ibrahim Index, 24th of 54 African states and just above the African average of 49.3, having improved 3.0 points over 2014–2023, but it is above the continental average on only 42 of the index's 96 indicators, and has no data at all for 14 of them (2023).

Legislation and regulation

Egypt's Cabinet agreed on 29 July 2026 to open a legislative review of the statutes governing social media, with increased financial penalties among the changes under consideration. The ICT minister's reason for it is the revealing part: the regulator's enforcement against AI-manipulated content already runs ahead of what the statute provides for, and nothing has been published about the unit doing that enforcing — no name, legal basis, size, detection method or route by which a detection can be contested. Parliament is divided: the communications committee deputy holds that the existing IT-crimes law needs only limited amendments and that the real gap is enforcement, while a Senate bloc leader presses for a minimum platform-use age modelled on Australia, the UK, Japan, China and the UAE.

What is on the books is older and thinner. The Telecommunication Regulation Law No. 10 of 2003 is the governing instrument for universal access, spectrum management and telecoms regulation; cross-government data sharing rests on Law No. 15 of 2004 on electronic signatures, the Personal Data Protection Law No. 151 of 2020 and Council of Ministers Decision No. 856 of 2010; and the National Elections Authority law of 2017 requires state agencies to share data with the Authority. Digital identity has no instrument of its own, the framework assembled from the Civil Status Law No. 143 of 1994, the data protection law and its executive regulations, Financial Regulatory Authority fintech decrees 139-141 of 2023, the Cybercrime Law No. 175 of 2018, the telecoms law, the Anti-Money Laundering Law No. 80 of 2002 and the 2014 Constitution's privacy guarantee. There is no right to information law in force, and the promised tax-refund window still awaits legislation.

Rule-making by regulator has been busier. The Financial Regulatory Authority's sandbox has received 49 projects, granted 7 preliminary approvals and cleared 2 into three-month renewable live testing, while giving regulatory guidance to a further 45 entities that never entered it (August 2026), and neither cleared project is a payments product. Under Board Resolution No. 51/2026, factoring companies must check the Authority's electronic platform in real time before financing any invoice.

Data protection

Enforcement of Egypt's Personal Data Protection Law is due to begin on 1 November 2026, at the close of the one-year compliance window opened by the November 2025 Executive Regulations — and three months out from that date the Personal Data Protection Centre was still running an awareness workshop on the law inside the Ministry of Social Solidarity. The law had sat five years without implementing rules before Ministerial Decision No. 816 of 2025 was published in the Official Gazette on 1 November 2025, setting detailed rules on collection, storage, sharing, biometric data, CCTV use and cross-border transfer, with a national-security carve-out under Article 3.

The Personal Data Protection Centre, established under Law No. 151 of 2020 and operating under the Information Technology Industry Development Agency, is the supervisory authority: it registers controllers and processors, licenses data processing, conducts inspections and enforces penalties, a position the Executive Regulations confirm. Controllers must appoint data protection officers and notify breaches within 72 hours — immediately where national security is implicated, with affected individuals told within three days of the authority. The regulations add safeguards for the processing of children's data, and transfers of personal data out of Egypt require a licence from the Centre. Individuals hold rights to access, correct and request deletion of their data, to object and to withdraw consent.

The one substantial enforcement to date came from a court, not the regulator. The Alexandria Economic Court awarded EGP 10 million against Orange Egypt in February 2025 over an unconsented SIM swap, grounding the operator's liability in tort and "custodian's liability" rather than in the data protection law, which had no implementing rules at the time.

Around the statute the direction has been the other way: Egypt's Digital Freedom score fell 11.8 points over 2014–2023 to 16.6 of 100, 51st of 54 African states, and Rights is its second worst-performing governance sub-category, at 16.0 and 52nd of 54 in 2023. In July 2026 an MP put on record that the Cybercrime Law and the Penal Code are insufficient to protect digital privacy, and called for a standalone privacy statute.

Regional collaboration

Egypt was elected on 31 July 2026 to chair two of the six working groups of the Arab Permanent Committee for AI and Emerging Technologies — AI governance and quantum computing, and no text, budget or timetable has been attached to either remit.

The chairmanships cap a year of Egyptian hosting. The committee implements a resolution of the 29th session of the Council of Arab Ministers of Communication and Information, which Egypt hosted in January 2026, and held its first founding meeting at the communications ministry's own headquarters in May 2026. Its mandate is to propose regional and international agreements and to coordinate a unified Arab position in international forums — a bloc-level standard-setting track running alongside rather than through the African Union's continental work.

Where the systems themselves cross the border, the reach is financial and one-directional. Inbound cross-border remittances have arrived instantly into accounts and wallets since December 2024, with bilateral links to other instant payment systems planned rather than live. The Central Bank casts its banking cooperation with Eswatini as part of a broader strategy of strengthening relations with African countries and supporting continental economic and financial integration, and has offered its currency-circulation system and the capability of the Egyptian Currency Printing House alongside its payments experience (July 2026) — an export of Egyptian arrangements rather than a joining of anyone else's.

Outside the region the ties are commercial and diplomatic rather than technical. Egypt and the United Kingdom agreed in January 2026 to strengthen ICT and offshoring cooperation, positioning Egypt as a delivery hub and a gateway to Africa for UK firms, and Egypt and Japan co-chair a "Water and Planet" dialogue at the 2026 UN Water Conference.

Standards

Egypt's platforms are further ahead than the rules that would govern them, and the governance layer is the part that has not been built. Egypt's whole-of-government data governance arrangement is planned or in progress rather than in place, follows a multilevel approach, and sits inside another institution rather than in a body of its own, and the government interoperability framework is still in draft or planned while the platform it would govern is recorded as only partially used (2025).

What standardisation there is has been done service by service, at launch. The public-shop licensing service unified fees across the participating agencies, with the Interior Ministry cutting its own by 50%, and gave a single back-office body a binding maximum approval time; the same launch produced the first verified reusable digital document, the business registration certificate, issued through the digital treasury for reuse across agencies (July 2026). That is a standard for one service, negotiated once, rather than a framework any other service inherits.

The published standards Egypt is most visibly shaping are regional and non-binding. The Arab Charter for AI Ethics is a 59-page document dated July 2025, prepared by the Arab AI Working Group of the League of Arab States and adopted by the 29th session of the Council of Arab Ministers of Communication and Information, setting out six pillars carrying roughly forty principles — identity and belonging, ethical innovation and technological autonomy, conscious use, flexible and effective governance, Arab integration and digital leadership, and comprehensive sustainability. It describes itself as an advisory and guiding document that is explicitly not a substitute for national policy or binding regulation — which is the ceiling on the working group Egypt now chairs, remitted to produce a guidance framework for AI governance, technical tools, and mechanisms for activating that charter.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Participation is Egypt's worst-scoring governance sub-category: 14.3 of 100 in 2023, 49th of 54 African states after a 9.7-point fall over the decade, with the deliberative and participatory governance measure inside it down 11.3 points to 35.7. The channels themselves exist — a citizen participation platform is in use, with petitions carried on the same portal (2025) — which is a statement about plumbing rather than about civic space.

The conditions for arguing with the state are worse than the means of petitioning it. Egypt scores 0.0 for Freedom of Association and Assembly in 2023, the lowest score the index awards, 44th of 54 and down 12.5 points over the decade, and 8.2 for Civil Society Space, 51st of 54; Media Freedom stands at 16.4, 53rd of 54.

Nor are the records there to argue with. There is no right to information law in force, the legislation still in draft with consultations in progress (2025), and the ability to obtain state records in practice remains among Egypt's weakest measures.

What scrutiny there is comes through the press and the trade bodies rather than through consultation. Five years into the tax digitisation programme, eight named practitioners told Al-Borsa that the reform digitised the taxpayer-facing interface while leaving the tax authority's back office on paper, and the federation of chambers of commerce running the awareness campaign for the new shop-licensing service is pressing publicly for every cost to be published and for no agency to levy new fees. Parliament's August 2026 debate on social media ran in the opposite direction, a committee deputy calling for the media regulator to adopt AI-based monitoring in place of human review so that offending content and accounts can be detected and closed immediately.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

The Central Bank of Egypt and Afreximbank signed a memorandum of understanding on 29 December 2025, between Governor Hassan Abdalla and Afreximbank President George Elombi, to establish a gold bank programme in Egypt — an internationally accredited refinery, secure vaulting and associated trading services, sited in a designated free zone. It fixes no capital and no timetable, and Egypt's place as the hub turns on a feasibility study and the approvals that would follow it.

Elsewhere the pattern is the same. ITIDA has signed a memorandum with EY MENA for a regional IT outsourcing delivery centre in Egypt (July 2026), and institutional agreements were signed during the Egyptian water minister's visit to Japan (August 2026). None of the memoranda commits a party to a sum or a date; they record intent, and the money, the scope and the timing are left to instruments that have yet to follow.

New investments

Under a fifth of the African Development Bank's court-automation grant to Egypt was ever drawn: XDR 376,350.87 of a XDR 1,890,224.56 commitment had been disbursed against a project window that closed in 2022. Running from 2016, it paid for an automated case management system for the Court of Cassation and for capacity in the Ministry of Justice in legislative drafting and open rule-making.

Almost everything else on the record dates from 2026. The National Telecommunications Regulatory Authority signed a spectrum agreement in February 2026 with Telecom Egypt, Vodafone Egypt, Orange Egypt and e& Egypt, releasing an additional 410 MHz and roughly doubling operators' holdings, and it has licensed Hassan Allam Digital Infrastructure, developing with A15, to build a data centre serving government, financial and business customers. Konecta opened a regional headquarters in Cairo with its first global generative-AI centre of excellence (July 2026). Blnk, a point-of-sale consumer lender, closed a raise combining equity led by Algebra Ventures with SANAD Fund for MSME and Endeavor Catalyst, and local-currency debt facilities from National Bank of Egypt, Suez Canal Bank and Bank Al Baraka Egypt (June 2026); the AI commerce startup Fincart took a seed round co-led by Launch Africa Ventures and Antler MENAP (July 2026). Not all of it has held: Telecom Egypt's board withdrew on 17 July 2026 from the agreed sale of a majority stake in its regional data-centre hub to Helios Investment Partners, the transaction's conditions unmet.

Six distinct commitments are on the record, with windows running from 2016 to 2028 and a converted value of around US$4 billion, and five of the six were announced or signed in 2026. Only one has money reported as moved. Five are private or commercial capital — three equity rounds, one spectrum award paid to the state and one licence-linked corporate investment — and the African Development Bank grant is the only public development finance among them. They fall in six different subsectors with no two sharing one, but the value does not spread with them: connectivity and data storage take almost all of it, leaving everything else a small fraction.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Egypt concluded a $3.5bn spectrum award to its four mobile operators in February 2026, releasing an additional 410MHz and roughly doubling the mobile spectrum in use in a single transaction. It followed commercial 5G, launched by the telecoms regulator in June 2025 and Telecom Egypt's $150m 5G licence of January 2024, and the ministry has committed to further tower building through 2028.

Coverage is close to saturated on the mobile side. 4G networks reached 98 percent of the population (2024), 95.4 percent of mobile connections were broadband-capable by late 2025, and 97.4 percent of Egyptians owned a mobile phone (2024). Fixed connections are far fewer, at 12.6 million fixed broadband subscriptions (November 2025), though Telecom Egypt's retail arm and Huawei launched fibre-to-the-room commercially in May 2026, the first such service in the country. Rural reach has come mainly through the Decent Life programme's village fibre rollout.

Internationally Egypt carries the largest concentration of submarine cable landings in Africa, and Telecom Egypt and Cisco activated capacity on the 2Africa cable's Mediterranean segment in January 2025. Domestic traffic exchange runs through one active internet exchange point, EG-IX, with moderate participation. Government connectivity is a separate build: the ICT 2030 strategy sets fibre to all 32,000 government entities by 2030.

Access is on closely identified terms. Handset IMEI registration through the regulator's Digital Service Platform has been mandatory since January 2025, on top of SIM registration against the original national ID card. The trajectory shows in the indices unevenly: Egypt's Internet & Computers score rose 24.3 points over 2014–2023 to 67.2 of 100, seventh of 54 African states and was its third most improved indicator of 96, while the mobile communications score moved 1.2 points over the same decade, to 75.5 and sixteenth.

Data Storage

Telecom Egypt's board withdrew on 17 July 2026 from the agreed sale of 75–80 percent of the unit owning its Regional Data Center Hub to Helios Investment Partners, saying the transaction's conditions had not been met, and will instead carve the hub out as a wholly-owned subsidiary — the largest domestic data-centre estate stays under a state-controlled operator. It sits alongside an integrated national data-centre strategy in preparation at the ICT ministry, ordered by presidential directive and framed on digital sovereignty and the localisation of data inside the country, aimed at making Egypt a regional hub for data storage and processing; the Cabinet reaffirmed the expansion of hyperscale construction on 5 July 2026.

No general localisation rule sits behind that language. The Cloud First Policy adopted in 2024 governs government cloud adoption, and localisation under it applies sectorally, to classified government data, rather than across the board; personal data is handled separately, through the authorisation requirement on cross-border transfers. Government's own workloads run on a private government cloud, hosted on a hybrid of facilities inside and outside government premises, across several platforms in central and local government (2025).

The commercial estate has grown fast, mostly through foreign vendors. Telecom Egypt operates Tier III facilities, its second regional data hub certified to that standard in 2024, alongside a market including Africa Data Centres, Gulf Data Hub, Khazna and Raya. Huawei Cloud opened a full public cloud region in Cairo in May 2024, the first hyperscaler region in Egypt, on a $300m five-year investment. Domestic capital is entering: Hassan Allam Digital Infrastructure, with A15, holds a licence for a $400m first phase of hosting, cloud and AI-ready capacity (June 2026), one of several data-centre licences issued in two years. Cooperation with SAP adds a European vendor track, though the sovereignty commitment in it is scoped to data and applications on SAP's own platforms — vendor-held rather than state-held. Power sets the outer limit, which the frontier proposals answer directly: a hyperscale data centre for Sinai running on green hydrogen and solar with seawater cooling was under ministerial review in March 2026.

Energy

Electricity is not what constrains Egypt's digital build. Firms reported an average of 0.8 outages a month, fewer than ten a year in the most recent enterprise survey, household access is effectively universal with no gap between urban and rural areas (2023), and Egypt takes a maximum 100.0 of 100 for Access to Energy on the Ibrahim Index, joint first of 54 African states (2023). Infrastructure is the country's best-performing governance sub-category in that index, at 83.2 of 100 and second of 54 after a 9.8-point decade rise (2023).

Price, not supply, is where the grid bites the household. The regulator's residential tariff is steeply tiered, from 0.68 EGP per kWh for the lowest bracket of 0-50 kWh to 2.58 EGP per kWh above 1,000 kWh under the 2024-2026 schedules, so a home that runs equipment continuously pays several times the rate of one that does not.

The generation mix moves more slowly than the connection figures. Renewables were a small share of electricity generation (2023). The regulatory frame around them has widened in the past two years: EgyptERA adopted a Smart Mini-Grids Regulatory Package in 2025, developed with the electricity ministry and the EU-funded MENALINKS programme, setting licensing, tariff-setting and ownership rules for renewable mini-grids intended for rural and remote communities, and Circular No. 3 of 2023 sets licensing, capacity and periodic reporting rules for off-grid self-consumption solar, with a national cap of 1,000 MW.

Technical Capacity

GitHub recorded more than 990,000 developers in Egypt in 2024, up 25 percent year on year, a base large enough that the constraint on building systems in-country is not the supply of people who can write software.

Inside government the picture is narrower. The Civil Status Information Center, a technical body of the interior ministry, runs day-to-day operation of the core national-number database in-country (2025), so the most sensitive register is operated by Egyptians on Egyptian premises — but the biometric hardware behind it has come from the French vendor IDEMIA in partnership with the local firm AOI. The wider administration is the weaker half: the Ibrahim Index places Egypt's effective administration near the bottom of the African range (2023), within a public administration sub-category that fell over the decade while overall governance rose. The public service does have both a digital skills strategy and a skills programme, with free training reaching advanced data science (2025), yet the depth that has reached ministries is thin: three months before the data protection law's compliance window closed, the Personal Data Protection Center was still running an awareness workshop on the law inside a ministry (August 2026).

The pipeline behind both is steady rather than expanding. ICT graduates are a modest share of tertiary output, and teaching capacity has thinned over the decade even as enrolment and completion rose.

Cybersecurity

Egypt scored a maximum 100 of 100 on the ITU Global Cybersecurity Index for 2023-2024, placing it in the index's top tier. The governing document behind that is the National Cybersecurity Strategy 2023-2027, published by the ICT ministry.

The binding obligations on operators sit in data protection law rather than in a dedicated cyber statute. Controllers and processors must notify the supervisory authority of a personal data breach on a short statutory deadline, immediately where national security is implicated, and tell affected people shortly afterwards, and the executive regulations require controllers to appoint data protection officers. Enforcement has started to appear in the courts: an Egyptian court awarded damages against a mobile operator over a SIM data breach in February 2025.

The state is extending its operational reach faster than its assurance practice. The telecoms regulator runs a unit that detects and acts on AI-manipulated video and imagery circulating on social platforms, announced in July 2026; the ICT ministry is to certify the system, data-centre and security specifications for the 2027 census; and Egypt chairs the Arab AI Committee working groups on AI governance and on quantum computing, the second remitted to produce an Arab strategy for quantum computing and quantum-cybersecurity deployment. On the workforce, the National Telecommunications Institute's Cybersecurity SuperHero Academy, in its third edition, aims to train more than 6,000 people across 17 governorates free of charge, delivered with EG-CERT alongside Fortinet and Cisco (July 2026).

DPI

Data Exchange

Egypt's government digital switch connected 105 government bodies and had linked 100 national databases as at July 2026, while the framework meant to govern that exchange was still in draft and the interoperability platform itself recorded as only partially used in 2025.

The core of central government already moves data across a Government Service Bus — financial management, tax administration, customs, human resources, social insurance and debt management — alongside separate point-to-point interfaces (2025). The Digital Egypt exchange run by MCIT links civil status, social insurance, tax, court, commercial registration and land and vehicle registry data (2025). The Unified National Registry, a World Bank-supported platform, connects 114 government databases through the national ID number and covers all Egyptian households (2024).

Where it works, it removes a step rather than adding a screen. GAFI issues a limited liability company's commercial registration, tax identification number, VAT registration and social insurance number together within one business day, with no separate approach to the tax authority, and holds live protocols with the Central Bank, the I-Score credit bureau, the Financial Regulatory Authority and the capital-market institutions for real-time verification of company registration data (2026). A link between the Public Prosecution and Interior Ministry traffic departments has ended the paper clearance certificate, and e-invoicing requires every document to carry either a company registration number or an individual's national ID number, binding tax records to the identity system.

Reach is thinner than the counts imply. The real estate registry's electronic integration with other bodies is concentrated in New Urban Communities Authority offices and pilot new cities rather than applied nationwide (2023), and inside the tax administration audit offices ask for paper copies of documents already held on the authority's own databases (July 2026). The sharpest current test is a welfare payment: the ministries behind the Unified Government Services Card describe its technical work as integration and data-sharing mechanisms among participating government entities (August 2026), which makes the exchange layer the mechanism behind who eats.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Egypt's telecoms regulator said on 8 August 2026 that a mobile line registered in a person's name does not by itself establish that person's criminal responsibility for its use, after citizens using its own lookup found lines registered against their national ID that they had never taken out — one of them a 19-year-old sentenced in absentia to 25 years. The regulator's answer arrived within a week: it tightened the registration rules, referred all four mobile operators to the prosecution and set a unified national digital-identity project alongside, and is expanding mandatory facial verification at enrolment through its know-your-customer system, linked to the civil registry. Verification at enrolment does not prevent a line being handed on afterwards, which is the gap the case turned on.

The answer was relaunching the "Arqamy" lookup inside the My NTRA app on 8 August 2026 with mid-digit masking of the numbers shown, pending face-recognition login, and to offer a complaint route and a move to biometric subscriber verification. Both add identity assurance; neither reduces what rests on the register.

The card gates ordinary life. Registration is mandatory from age 15 under the Civil Status Law of 1994, and every citizen is assigned a unique 14-digit number by the civil registry at birth registration, with cross-checks against duplicate registration (2025). Account opening requires the national ID under Central Bank and anti-money-laundering rules, and mobile wallet registration requires a valid national ID number; buying a SIM requires presentation of the original card; the number is required for the Takaful and Karama cash transfer, with applicant data cross-checked against the Unified National Registry, and for enrolment in the Universal Health Insurance System; foreign residents hold no such card.

Three biometric platforms now run in parallel above that one register. The Central Bank launched Haweya in November 2025, a face-and-fingerprint eKYC app opening a bank account remotely at 37 banks; the Interior Ministry launched MOIEG-PASS in February 2026, scanning the card and matching the face before granting access to services; MCIT's own app added liveness detection and integrated e-signature by July 2026. Oversight is split to match — the core system with the Interior Ministry, Haweya with the Central Bank, and digital ID rules for non-bank finance with the Financial Regulatory Authority, whose Decree No. 140 of 2023 makes biometric verification mandatory for fintech transactions. Holding the number is becoming a precondition of due process: Bareedi, Egypt Post's digital postbox, is bound to the holder's national ID and carries e-signed judicial notices.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Financial inclusion reached 79% of the eligible adult population by June 2026, on 56.4 million active bank, postal, wallet and prepaid-card accounts against an eligible population of 71.4 million — a 229% rise since 2016.

The rail underneath is the Instant Payment Network, launched in March 2022 and reached through the InstaPay app, giving 24/7 real-time interoperable transfers across bank accounts, mobile wallets and cards, owned, overseen and settled by the Central Bank and operated by its technical subsidiary the Egyptian Banks Company. InstaPay passed 16 million users and carried EGP 4.2 trillion between July 2024 and June 2025, and alongside it 55.5 million mobile wallet accounts moved roughly EGP 1.8 trillion in the year to June 2025.

What that rail costs turns on a board decision rather than a statute. The Central Bank exempted individuals from all charges on electronic-channel Egyptian pound transfers from 1 January 2025 for three renewable months; from 1 April 2025 transfers have carried a fee of 0.1% capped at EGP 20, ending three years of free instant transfers. The rules are no more public: only the original October 2021 scheme rules were published, the current iterations being available to participating banks alone.

Acceptance is thickening — over 26,000 ATMs and roughly 275,000 point-of-sale terminals at the end of 2025 — and the Central Bank launched SoftPOS in February 2026 so a merchant can take contactless payments on an ordinary NFC phone. Inbound cross-border remittances have settled instantly into accounts and wallets since December 2024.

Government money runs on the same plumbing: e-Finance operates the government payments network and handles receipts including taxes, customs and social insurance contributions, and the pensions authority completed a digital disbursement covering some 10.2 million beneficiaries by February 2026. The Financial Regulatory Authority runs a digital factoring portal to stop the same invoice being financed twice (February 2026). Payment customers sit under a regime of their own: Law No. 194 of 2020 gives Central Bank licensees their own rules on customer protection and dispute settlement, and the general consumer protection law does not apply to them.

Registries

Fewer than 10 percent of properties in Egypt are legally registered, around 25 percent of agricultural parcels being under the title system (2026), after a decade of registry digitisation.

The machinery is being rebuilt on an identifier: a National Real Estate Identification System under Law No. 88 of 2025 gives each property a unique digital ID tied to a unified national base map, with roll-out partial and executive regulations still in preparation. The title register moves at another pace entirely: it is governed by Law 142 of 1964 and applied survey section by survey section, each section needing its own ministerial commencement decision, so there is no national completion date, and in a decision gazetted on 4 August 2026 the justice ministry deferred commencement for one survey section of Manshah, in Sohag, from 1 July 2026 to 1 July 2027, twenty-six years after that section was brought within the system.

The National Platform for Regularising State Lands had taken more than 302,000 applications under Law 168 of 2025 by 4 August 2026, against about 1,700 regularisation contracts drawn up.

That is a completion rate of roughly 0.6 percent on the applications received.

The population side is in a different condition. The population register, the civil register and the national identity system are a single fully digitised database at the Civil Status Organisation, births, deaths, marriages and divorces being recorded directly against a record keyed on the citizen's national number, so the three are integrated by design rather than by linkage. Electronic birth and death notification has run since 2017 at around 4,571 health offices, rural facilities included, which transmit to civil registry offices for compilation, and 1.96 million births were registered in 2024. The electoral roll is derived from that register rather than canvassed, and covered over 67 million voters at the December 2023 presidential election.

The Tax Authority runs a nationwide digital taxpayer registry keyed on a taxpayer identification number (2025), and the Takaful and Karama social registry holds around 11.3 million households, of which 4.67 million were enrolled in the transfer itself by December 2023.

Sectoral management information systems

Egypt's National Social Insurance Authority says its new system served 8,621,000 people in about four months to August 2026 and now both disburses pensions monthly and collects contributions, having paid 167,500 arrears cases and cleared 92% of an accumulated backlog as at 1 August 2026.

Every core government transaction system the GovTech Maturity Index assesses for Egypt is recorded as in use — financial management, treasury, tax administration, customs, human resources, payroll, social insurance, debt management and e-procurement — and the national public service portal is transactional rather than informational, so front office and back office alike sit at the index's upper bands (2025).

The systems themselves are mostly bought in: the financial management information system runs on commercial off-the-shelf software, and tax administration and customs are both hybrids of custom and off-the-shelf products (2025). The practitioner account is less tidy: eight named practitioners told Al-Borsa that the reform digitised the taxpayer-facing interface while leaving the authority's back office on paper (July 2026), though the same portal carries the e-invoicing system mandatory since December 2022.

The health ministry launched DHIS2 as its national health information system in January 2026, under the National Digital Health Strategic Priorities 2025-2029, with full interoperability with the wider national ecosystem still under development. Separately, primary care units in the six Phase I governorates of the Universal Health Insurance System have been fully digitised, with electronic health records, e-prescriptions and unit-level archiving standard down to village facilities.

Elsewhere the systems work inside their own walls. The interior and communications ministries run an integrated Digital Justice Platform whose police-station module issues complaints and records electronically into the Public Prosecution's paperless case management, extended to 118 police departments by late 2025. Agriculture's systems — the fertiliser and seed smart-card scheme, the Hudhud pest-identification app and the GeoAgro-Misr advisory platform — remain standalone and outside the national data exchange (2025). And the irrigation ministry states that data exchange between its own internal sectors is the enabling requirement for its planned water system, and is auditing what each sector already holds in order to merge them (July 2026).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Egypt ranked 22nd on the World Bank's 2025 GovTech Maturity Index, up from 69th in 2022 on a score of 0.911, while placing around 95th of 193 states on the UN's 2024 E-Government Development Index.

Launched in 2020, the Digital Egypt platform had 10.7 million registered users and 210 services at the start of January 2026, 73 of them exclusively online, and 242 services and about 20 million transactions by July 2026; transactions rose from 7.8 million in 2024 to more than 25 million in 2025.

The state is closing the paper counter behind it. Nine commercial-registry services became available exclusively through Digital Egypt from 1 January 2026, and GAFI's investment e-licensing platform offers 460 services from 41 government issuers. In July 2026 the local development and communications ministries launched public-shop licensing on the platform, on the government service bus, digital identity, e-signature and the digital treasury, producing the first verified reusable digital document, the business registration certificate.

Citizen-facing services are narrower than the totals suggest. The Public Prosecution's electronic enquiry returns only judgments held on its own system and registered against the enquirer's own national number, and its result is stated not to substitute for official certificates or extracts. Cairo airport began issuing visas on arrival as a QR code from 1 August 2026, valid seven days, with paper running in parallel for a transition, and the digital channel carries an issuance fee on top of the visa fee, so the switch is monetised rather than absorbed. Where a service needs a decision, the counter reappears: flagging an unrecognised mobile line in the My NTRA app cannot cancel or transfer it, and the citizen must still attend the carrier in person with the physical card.

E-procurement is in use and publishes tender notices and awarded contracts (2025). The gaps are access and delivery: the Digital Egypt portal lacks features supporting access for people with disabilities, and the 95 online social-insurance services promised in February 2026 "within six months" had not arrived when that window fell due, leaving most of the authority's roughly 170 services still requiring an office visit.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

A licensing regime the governorates administer moved onto the national platform in July 2026, when the Ministry of Local Development and MCIT launched public-shop licensing on Digital Egypt, built on the government service bus, digital identity, e-signature and the digital treasury. Fees were unified across the participating agencies, the Interior Ministry cutting its own by half, and a single back-office body was given a binding maximum approval time. The enforcement half went with it: the penalties of Public Shops Law 154 of 2019 are to be applied to unlicensed premises and licence breaches, with governorate agencies canvassing commercial premises and mobile technology vans taking applications on site. The service is being presented as the model for moving other licensing regimes across.

The plumbing beneath it does reach below the national level. A secured government-to-government network links around 33,000 institutions across the 27 governorates (2024), and the financial management information system, commercial off-the-shelf, is in extensive use across central and sub-national government alike (2025). The direction of travel is now back down the same wires: under the FY2026/27 development plan the integrated population databases are used to assess each governorate's performance on the population file, with incentives tied to the result (2026).

Rural digital data capture

Fibre had reached more than 1,250 of the 1,450 villages targeted by the Decent Life programme by mid-2026, some five million lines laid across 20 governorates, and the build has accelerated year on year — 267 villages by the end of 2023, 856 by the end of 2024 and past a thousand during 2025. The Ministry of Communications and Information Technology restated the village figure to the World Bank on 17 July 2026 and named Decent Life as the vehicle for its rural connectivity work; 1,367 mobile towers have gone up in rural areas under the same programme (2024), and rules for licensing and pricing renewable mini-grids intended for remote communities were adopted in 2025.

Fewer than 200 of the targeted villages were still without fibre by mid-2026.

What runs over the connection has moved more slowly. Clinic-level digitisation under the health insurance system — electronic records, e-prescribing and unit-level archiving reaching village facilities — has been completed in the first-phase governorates rather than nationally (2026), and police record-keeping outside the largest cities has not moved off paper alongside the Digital Justice Platform (2026). The digitised agricultural systems that do reach farmers — the smart-card scheme tying fertiliser, pesticide and seed quotas to holdings, a pest-identification app, a climate advisory service — run as standalone sectoral systems outside the national data exchange (2025), so what they capture stays where it was captured. Ration-card grievances and data updates are still taken over the counter at post offices (July 2026).

The rural economy those systems describe has barely shifted. Egypt's rural economy score rose 0.8 points over 2014–2023, to 67.8 of 100 and 15th of 54 African states (2023), and within it land and water access is the strongest component at 77.3 and eighth in Africa while rural representation and participation is the weakest at 60.7 and thirty-third, market access having fallen 3.0 points over the decade (2023). The national strategy itself acknowledges the urban–rural digital divide that the village build is meant to close.

Technology

AI

Egypt's telecommunications regulator has a unit in operation that detects and acts on AI-manipulated video and imagery circulating on social platforms (July 2026), and the ICT minister told Cabinet the same month that enforcement already runs ahead of what the statute provides for. Nothing has been enacted to close the gap: in August 2026 the Communications Committee was still arguing that the existing IT-crimes law needs limited amendment rather than new legislation, and no watermarking mandate or AI-monitoring requirement has been legislated.

Elsewhere what runs is sectoral: agriculture's pest-identification app and climate advisory platform are standalone systems outside the national data exchange (2025), and the first clearances into live testing in the financial regulator's sandbox include an insurer's remote motor-damage assessment (August 2026). In the government exchange layer the record is of memoranda rather than systems: MCIT has signed with IBM on generative AI for government institutions and with Huawei on AI capabilities (2024).

The state's own AI building is a sovereign Arabic large language model programme, Karnak, and a responsible-AI centre, ECRAI, both dating from late 2025; the minister presents Karnak alongside the Applied Innovation Centre's work converting research into applications for state and society, and AI in early disease detection (August 2026), leaning on the university skilling pipeline and the hyperscale data-centre build-out reaffirmed by Cabinet in July 2026.

The paper architecture is now two strategies deep. A Second National Artificial Intelligence Strategy was adopted in 2025 on six pillars, following the National Council for AI of 2019, the first strategy of 2021 and the Responsible AI Charter of 2023, and the council's remit has been widened to take in quantum computing and emerging technologies alongside AI. Regionally Egypt chairs the Arab AI Governance Working Group, whose task is to activate an Arab Charter for AI Ethics that describes itself as advisory and expressly not a substitute for national policy or binding regulation.

Bilateral work repeats the pattern: the water minister's August 2026 agreements with Japan name AI and digital models for monitoring water structures and reducing flood risk, with no money, named system or implementation date attached.

ICT Industry

Egypt's IT outsourcing exports stood at $4.8bn in 2025, roughly double the $2.4bn of 2022 — the sector's clearest growth line, and the one the state's industrial pitch is built on.

That pitch places Egypt as the delivery location rather than the vendor. EY MENA has agreed with ITIDA to establish a regional IT outsourcing delivery centre in the country (July 2026); Konecta has opened a Cairo regional headquarters together with a generative-AI centre of excellence (July 2026); Egypt and the United Kingdom agreed in January 2026 to strengthen ICT and offshoring cooperation, positioning Egypt as a delivery hub and a gateway to Africa for UK firms; and cooperation with SAP on cloud, AI and outsourcing was deepened in March 2026. What these arrangements sell is Egyptian labour and Egyptian floor space to firms headquartered elsewhere.

Underneath sits a domestic sector of real size. Fawry is the country's largest electronic payments platform and Egyptian-owned, and the developer population counted on the main code-hosting platform is large and growing quickly (2024). Ownership of the infrastructure layer is moving towards the state rather than away from it: Telecom Egypt cancelled the sale of a stake in its Regional Data Center Hub and will instead carve the estate out as a wholly-owned subsidiary, leaving it under a state-controlled operator (July 2026).

Government technology spending reaches domestic suppliers through a programme to support GovTech startups and public-private arrangements for delivering online public services (2025), though neither the programme nor any of the partnerships is named in the record.

Innovation ecosystem

Egypt is North Africa's leading startup ecosystem by funding, with US$524m raised in the second half of 2025, and the year's notable exit was GlobalFoundries' acquisition of the Egyptian chip-design startup InfiniLink — a hardware exit in an ecosystem whose money mostly goes to fintech.

The state's financing instrument is the Egypt Startup Charter, which attaches a headline EGP 50bn to a target of 5,000 startups (December 2025). Private capital has been arriving for longer than the charter has existed: Partech counted around US$297m of equity funding into Egyptian tech startups in 2024, among Africa's top three venture destinations.

The supporting institutions are dense. A commercial directory listed 39 accelerators and incubators in January 2025, with the African Development Bank's mapping identifying dozens more university-based incubators, including 48 supported by the Academy of Scientific Research and Technology.

Absorption is the weaker half. The financial regulator's sandbox has produced far more advisory guidance to firms than it has authorisations, with only its first projects reaching live testing (August 2026). Government has both a public sector innovation strategy and a programme, with an established innovation lab working on digital skills and public service innovation (2025), and its open source software policy is advisory rather than mandatory (2025), which limits how far public procurement can be a route in for domestic developers. On the outside measure, Egypt ranked 86th in the WIPO Global Innovation Index 2024, within a confidence interval of 82nd to 88th.

Capacity

Literacy

Egypt is near the top of Africa for getting children through school and near the bottom for doing it evenly: Education Completion reached 94.2 of 100 and fifth of 54 African states in 2023, up 14.7 points over the decade, with Education Quality up 15.9 points to 55.2 and Enrolment up 5.5 points to 56.8, while over the same ten years Equality in Education fell 1.1 points to 35.1 of 100, 44th of 54 (2023). The weakest of Egypt's education measures is the one that says who the gains reached.

The teaching base thinned as the intake grew. Human Resources in Education is among the ten most deteriorated Ibrahim Index indicators for Egypt, down 11.3 points over 2014–2023 to 86.2 of 100 and 25th of 54 — high in absolute terms, and falling while completion climbed.

The digital floor inside the classroom is uneven in the same direction. Primary schools share devices far more thinly than secondary and technical ones, so day-to-day attendance and record-keeping is still done on paper before it is aggregated into the education MIS (2025), even though the great majority of Egypt's schools now meet the Ministry of Education's "smart school" criteria. Outside school, the same floor is what the payments push keeps meeting: low digital financial literacy is named alongside entrenched cash habits and fraud exposure as a brake on digital payment adoption (July 2026).

Training and skills

Egypt publishes something almost no other African AI-skilling programme does — a running total. The MCIT/Dell "AI Capacity Building Initiative for Universities" has trained 2,710 students and produced 763 projects cumulatively since 2022, and its fourth round closed on 4 August 2026 with 1,090 students from ten public, private and national universities delivering 445 projects across smart agriculture, smart traffic, smart government, digital healthcare and the smart economy. A parallel hackathon on new and renewable energy under the same initiative drew 105 students in 21 teams from ten universities, ten teams reaching the final, with Dell supplying healthcare datasets so that students worked on real data.

What the running total does not carry is what happened next. No cost, no funding split between the ministry and Dell, no placement or employment outcome for any cohort, and no account of what became of the 763 projects has been published (August 2026). A participation count is not a completion count, and a project count is not an adoption count.

Beneath the AI programmes, the state trains its own. Egypt has both a digital skills strategy and a digital skills programme for the public service, free to take and extending as far as advanced data science and deep learning (2025). The pipeline feeding it is narrow: ICT graduates are around 10.5 percent of Egypt's tertiary graduates and STEM graduates around 20.8 percent, with Egypt 79th of 123 countries on the Global Knowledge Index ICT sub-index (2021). Absorption is being sought abroad rather than at home: cooperation agreed with the United Kingdom in January 2026 positions Egypt as an offshoring delivery hub and a gateway to Africa for UK firms.

Training reaches beyond software. The National Telecommunications Institute runs a free cybersecurity academy with EG-CERT and vendor partners across the governorates (July 2026), and Egypt has looked to Japan's water-related disaster centre for training Egyptian engineers on flood forecast models and risk maps (August 2026).

Research institutions

Egypt is building models rather than only buying them: a sovereign Arabic large language model programme called "Karnak" and a responsible-AI centre, ECRAI, both date from late 2025. The ICT minister places these alongside the university AI pipeline and the Applied Innovation Centre, describing the centre's work as converting research into applications for the state and society and naming Karnak beside AI in early disease detection (August 2026) — the ministry's own account of one effort running from student projects to a national model.

The institutional base under it is broad. Tracxn's directory listed 39 accelerators and incubators in Egypt as of January 2025, and the African Development Bank's ecosystem mapping identifies dozens more university-based incubators, 48 of them supported by the Academy of Scientific Research and Technology. Output ranks lower than the institutional count suggests: Egypt placed 86th in the WIPO Global Innovation Index 2024, within a confidence interval of 82nd to 88th.

Inclusion

Access to services

Egypt's Equal Access to Public Services score is unchanged over 2014–2023 at 42.5 of 100, 24th of 54 African states: a decade of service reform has not shifted how equally services reach different groups.

What has changed is obligation. In December 2024 the National Telecom Regulatory Authority extended accessibility requirements to mobile e-wallet services, requiring accessible interfaces, sign-language support, Braille contracts and discounted tariffs for people with disabilities, on top of a 2021 Central Bank rule that banks adapt at least a tenth of branches and ATMs with Braille keypads and audio guidance, offer sign-language service including by video call, keep digital channels screen-reader compatible and waive minimum balances and fees. Its own front door lags: the Digital Egypt portal lacks features supporting access for people with disabilities (2024), even as a National Academy for IT for Persons with Disabilities operates separately.

The counter has not gone away. Ration-card grievances and data updates run through 500 post offices (July 2026), making Egypt Post the physical desk for ministry digital services; most of the social insurance authority's services still require an office visit (August 2026); and flagging an unrecognised mobile line in the regulator's app still ends with a visit to the carrier and the physical ID card (August 2026). Universal health insurance enrolment is gated on the national ID and, as at June 2024, confined to the first-phase governorates.

Non-nationals are served on a parallel track. Egypt's Civil Status Law requires health offices to register the births and deaths of resident foreign nationals, and refugees follow the same birth registration procedure, though foreign parents can face demands for a marriage certificate or residence permit (2025). UNHCR-registered refugees collect bimonthly cash assistance at more than 4,000 Egypt Post branches on an iris scan or a UNHCR card, reaching around 16 percent of the refugee population, while mainstream mobile money accounts are keyed to the national identification refugees do not hold (2025).

Financial inclusion stands at 72.5 percent for women and 58 percent for Egyptians aged 15 to 35 as at June 2026, both climbing faster than the national headline.

Digital divides

Mobile phone ownership in Egypt is close to parity between men and women, yet 65 percent of men and 54 percent of women use mobile internet (2023): an eleven-point gap sitting on top of near-identical handset ownership, so the line runs through use rather than through owning the device.

The service measures move the other way. Egypt's Access to Public Services for Women score rose 9.7 points over 2014–2023 to 44.9 of 100, 25th of 54 African states, and Socioeconomic Opportunity for Women rose 17.5 points to 64.1, 10th of 54 — among the strongest decade movements anywhere in Egypt's record.

Geography is the divide the state names itself: Egypt Vision 2030 records a significant divide between urban and rural areas, with rural internet access lagging the national rate (2024). It is not a divide in basic utilities — electricity reaches effectively the whole population, with no gap between town and country (2023) — and the Decent Life fibre and mobile-tower programme has been building village connections since, with Telecom Egypt's laying of lines still short of the target village count as at June 2026.

Inside the school system the divide is by stage. Egyptian primary schools average 95 students to each shared digital device, against close to one-to-one ratios in secondary and technical education (2025), so day-to-day attendance and record-keeping in primary schools is still taken on paper before it reaches the education management system. That sits alongside equality in education, the weakest of Egypt's education measures and slightly worse in 2023 than a decade earlier, even as internet and computer access has been among its most improved indicators of any kind. Coverage has risen faster than the evenness of its distribution.

Data

National statistics

Egypt's 2027 population, housing and establishments census is designed as a register-based exercise rather than a field count, assembled from central statistical registers of buildings and units, households, individuals and establishments — and the presidential decree authorising it was still pending as at 20 July 2026, waiting on a property-wealth map and a secure electronic data exchange that must both be finalised first. The government means to hold the cost down by reusing tablets from earlier rounds and activating inter-agency data exchange in place of new collection, and MCIT is to certify the system, data-centre and security specifications the exercise will run on.

The survey programme behind that shift is uneven. A population census and a business census had been run within the ten years to 2023, while the most recent agricultural census fell in the decade before that; over the same period Egypt ran three or more household, labour force and health surveys and two agricultural surveys, but no business or establishment survey at all. On the same measures, data use scores above 89%, with data services, data products, data sources and data infrastructure all in the 70–89% band (2023).

Egypt scores 70.1 of 100 for the capacity of its statistical system (2023), seventh of 54 African states, a score that has slipped a point over the decade. The same profile leaves its public-perception indicators unscored for Egypt, so the governance record carries no citizen-reported layer at all.

Administrative data is being asked to do more. The FY2026/27 development plan expands integrated databases that allow population indicators to be followed in real time, with the same base tracking fertility, early marriage and contraceptive uptake and the results used to assess governorate performance and tie incentives to what each governorate achieves on the population file. For the national accounts, the planning ministry has stood up Bayan, a platform for collecting the underlying figures from ministries electronically (2024).

Open data

Egypt adopted its first National Open Data Policy in August 2025, as a transitional framework pending a data governance law — but there is still no right to ask for what the state does not choose to publish, the right to information law remaining in draft with consultations in progress (2025).

That asymmetry is visible in the scores. Disclosure of Public Records rose 13.3 points over 2014–2023 to 34.0 of 100, 25th of 54 African states, while Accessibility of Public Records stands at 18.7 of 100 and 41st of 54, up only 4.2 points across the same decade: what the state elects to publish has improved several times faster than what a citizen can obtain on request. Accountability and Transparency, at 19.2 of 100 and 45th of 54 in 2023, slipped slightly over the decade even as the overall governance score rose.

On the 2024 Open Data Inventory the economic series come out best, national accounts, balance of payments, government finance, trade, labour and banking statistics each scoring 6 out of 10 for openness and coverage, and prices 5. The social series are weaker and far more uneven — population 6, education outcomes 5, gender statistics 4, health facilities 4, food security 3.5, and poverty and health outcomes 3 apiece — while environmental data sits in a narrow band, agriculture at 5.5 down to the built environment and pollution at 4.5.

Delivery runs ahead of the rules. Egypt operates a government open data portal carrying a comprehensive data catalogue and updated weekly or daily, though the publication process behind it is mostly manual, and the e-procurement system publishes both tender notices and awarded contracts (2025). Where publication is discretionary it thins quickly: only the original 2021 rules for the instant payment network are on the central bank's site, the current iterations going to participating banks alone.

Much of the documentation behind Egypt's government digital systems is recorded in the 2025 GovTech Maturity Index as existing but internal and unpublished, across most of its indicator families.

Use of satellite data

Earth observation surfaces first in water management: the irrigation ministry said in August 2026 that it intends to draw on Japan's GSMaP satellite rainfall product to monitor rainfall across Nile Basin states, and to sharpen hydrological forecasting, soil-moisture estimates and estimates of what agriculture actually needs. In land administration the National Real Estate Identification System resolves each property's digital identifier through a land, building, unit and street hierarchy tied to a unified national base map (2025), and the Egyptian Survey Authority's cadastral mapping is linked to the digital property registry.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

American infrastructure in Egypt runs through the cable layer: Telecom Egypt and Cisco activated subsea capacity on the Mediterranean segment of the 2Africa cable system in January 2025, and Egypt is a landing and transit country on that system, whose consortium includes Meta alongside European, Chinese and African operators. Inside the state's own systems the American presence is at the memorandum stage, the communications ministry having signed a memorandum of understanding with IBM on generative artificial intelligence for government institutions (2024).

China activities

Huawei Cloud opened a full public cloud region in Cairo in May 2024, the first hyperscaler cloud region in Egypt, on a five-year investment of 300 million US dollars. The same partnership reaches into the retail network, where Telecom Egypt's consumer arm WE and Huawei launched fibre-to-the-room commercially in May 2026, the first such service in the country, and into finance, where Huawei signed a memorandum of understanding with the Egyptian brokerage Thndr at a Cairo fintech summit in June 2026, pitching cloud, artificial intelligence and data-management services at firms unable to build infrastructure of their own. In government the relationship stands where the American one does: the communications ministry has a memorandum of understanding with Huawei on artificial intelligence capabilities (2024). China Mobile also sits in the 2Africa consortium, giving Chinese carriers a stake in the cable that lands on Egypt's coast as well as in the cloud region and the access network above it.

EU activities

The sovereignty commitment in Egypt's cooperation with SAP is scoped to data and applications hosted on SAP's own platforms, which makes it sovereignty held by the vendor rather than by the state (March 2026); it came as Egypt and SAP deepened cooperation on cloud, artificial intelligence and outsourcing, adding a European vendor track to the cloud estate alongside the Chinese one. European money also sits behind regulation rather than only behind plant: EgyptERA adopted a dedicated Smart Mini-Grids Regulatory Package in 2025, developed with the electricity ministry and the EU-funded MENALINKS programme, setting licensing, tariff-setting and ownership rules for renewable mini-grids meant to serve rural and remote communities. The Netherlands is the counterpart on water, where the irrigation ministry is developing an integrated digital system for forecasting, managing and distributing water under phase two of the JCAR 2 applied research programme run with the Dutch side (July 2026). The oldest European position is in hardware: the French vendor IDEMIA has held recurring contracts for biometric device production in partnership with the local firm AOI, leaving the identity estate reliant on a foreign supplier for its biometric devices even as assembly happens in Egypt.

Gulf/UAE activities

The Central Bank of Egypt enabled instant inbound cross-border remittances in December 2024, letting recipients take funds straight into bank accounts or wallets through the Instant Payment Network, with further bilateral links planned to Jordan, Saudi Arabia and the UAE. The Gulf's place in those rails is therefore a set of planned connections rather than working ones.

India activities

Egypt and India agreed at the BRICS industry ministers' meeting in Jaipur on 7 August 2026 to explore linking their payment systems and to settle bilateral trade in local currencies in order to cut transfer costs.

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